

The Eight Tones

Irmos

Note: For those studying the eight tones of this style, please check out ToneTutor 101 for a guided course:
<https://www.ocrb.org/products/tonetutor101>

Tone 1

The melody for Irmos of the first tone is abbreviated "Greek" chant. This consists of 3 strophes, in which the first two repeat as needed and the third is the final strophe.

The pattern: 1, 2, 1, 2,.....Final.

Strophe 1

Thy vic - tor - i - ous right arm hath in godly manner

been glo - ri - fied in strength; for as almighty, O Im - mor - tal One,

2 Final:

it smote the ad - ver - sa - ry, fashioning anew the path of the

deep for the Is - ra - e - lites.

Tone 2

The melody for Irmos of the second tone is a variation of abbreviated Znamenny chant. This consists of 4 strophes, in which the first three repeat as needed and the fourth is the final strophe. Note that 1a and 1b are similar but have a minor difference at the beginning: 1b omits the melodic at the beginning of the strophe 1a and instead begins with recitative on "g". Strophe 1b does not occur in the example below. 1a is only used at the beginning, but 1b is used afterwards after strophe 3..

The pattern: 1a, 2, 3, 1b, 2, 3, 1b, 2, 3,....Final.

Strophe 1

Once the pow'r of the Almighty overwhelmed Pharaoh's whole ar-my in the deep;

2

and the in-car-nate Word hath destroyed per-ni-cious sin,

3

for our most glo-ri-ous Lord,

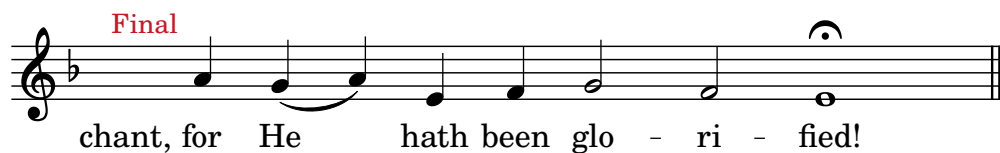
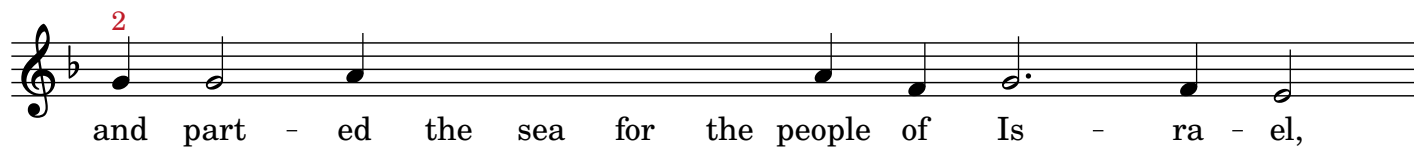
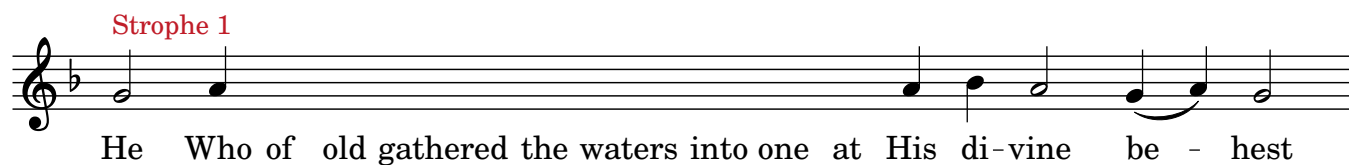
Final

hath glo-rious ly been glo-ri-fied.

Tone 3

The melody for Irmos of the third tone is abbreviated Kievan chant. This consists of 3 strophes, in which the first two repeat as needed and the third is the final strophe.

The pattern: 1, 2, 1, 2,.....Final.



Tone 4

The melody for Irmos of the fourth tone is abbreviated "Greek" chant. This consists of 3 strophes, in which the first two repeat as needed and the third is the final strophe.

The pattern: 1, 2, 1, 2,.....Final.

Strophe 1

Is - ra - el of old, having traversed the depths of the Red Sea

2

with dry - shod feet, vanquished the might of A - ma - lek

1

2

Final

in the wil - der - ness by Moses' hands up - lif - ted in the form of a Cross.

Tone 5

The melody for Irmos of the fifth tone is a variation of abbreviated Znamenny chant. This consists of 5 strophes, in which the first four repeat as needed and the fifth is the final strophe. Notes: the second and third strophes are often combined. The fourth strophe is used before the final strophe.

The pattern: 1, 2, 3, or (2-3), 4, Final.

Strophe 1

Bring-ing bat - tles to nought with His up - raised arm,

2

Christ hath overthrown horse and ri - der in the Red Sea,

3

and hath saved Is - ra - el, who chanteth a hymn of vic - to - ry.

4

and hath saved Is - ra - el, who chanteth a hymn of vic - to - ry.

Final

and hath saved Is - ra - el, who chanteth a hymn of vic - to - ry.

Tone 6

The melody for Irmos of the second tone is a variation of abbreviated Znamenny chant. This consists of 4 strophes, in which the first three repeat as needed and the fourth is the final strophe. Note that the application of the final strophe can vary according to the length of the text.

The pattern: 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3,..... Final.

Strophe 1

Tra-ver-sing the deep on foot, as though it were dry_____ land,

3

and be-hold - ing the ty-rant Pha - raoh drowned, Is - ra - el cried a - loud:

1

Let us chant_ un - to God a hymn of vic - to - ry!

Final

Tone 7

The melody for Irmos of the third tone is modified Kievan chant. This consists of 3 strophes, in which the first two repeat as needed and the third is the final strophe. Note that the first strophe varies as 1a and 1b. 1a is applied only at the beginning where a phrase is short (about five syllables or less) and 1b is applied where a phrase is longer. **The pattern: 1a, 2, 1b, 2, 1b, 2,.....Final.**

The musical notation is written on a single staff in G major (one flat). The melody consists of three strophes. The first strophe is labeled 'Strophe 1b' and '1b'. The second strophe is labeled '2'. The third strophe is labeled 'Final'.

By Thy_____ hand was the na-ture of wa-ter, which be-fore was flu-id,

trans-formed into solid form, O Lord. Where-fore, having passed through it dry-shod,

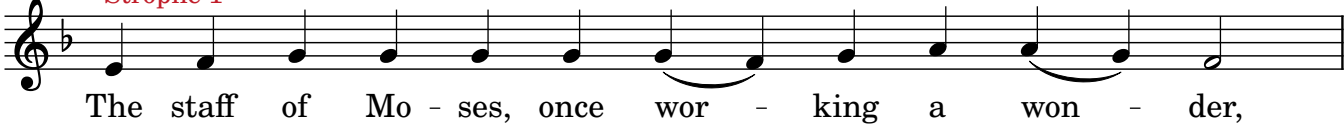
Israel chanteth to Thee a hymn a vic-to-ry.

Tone 8

The melody for Irmos of the fourth tone is abbreviated "Greek" chant. This consists of 3 strophes, in which the first two repeat as needed and the third is the final strophe. Please note that the second strophe has some variation in the melodic contour.

The pattern: 1, 2, 1, 2,.....Final.

Strophe 1



The staff of Mo - ses, once wor - king a won - der,

2



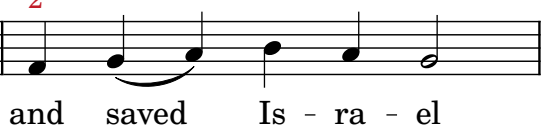
stri-king the sea in the form of a cross and di - vi - ding it,

1



drowned the moun-ted ty - rant Pha - raoh,

2



and saved Is - ra - el

Final



who fled on foot, chan - ting a hymn un - to God.